

The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, APRIL 13, 2026

US fires judge linked to Öztürk's case

Patel blocked Trump administration's bid to deport Tufts student; others also dismissed

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration has fired the immigration judge who terminated the government's deportation proceedings against Rümeysa Öztürk, the Tufts University graduate student who was arrested last year by ICE agents on a Somerville street.

The judge, Roopal Patel, was based at the Boston immigration court and was nearing the end of her two-year probationary period when she received a notice Friday that she was being dismissed, she said in an interview with the Globe

Sunday.

"Even though I was expecting it, it was still sort of shocking," Patel said. "The consequences are immediate."

Several other judges in Massachusetts and at immigration courts in other states were also fired in recent weeks, including the Chelmsford immigration judge who earlier this year terminated the government's deportation proceedings against Columbia University student and Palestinian activist Mohsen Mahdawi. The dismissals were first reported by The New York Times.

JUDGES, Page A4



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

"Even though I was expecting it, it was still sort of shocking," Judge Roopal Patel said.

Boston Sand sues over use of access lane

Warns of pedestrian deaths if development is built

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

In an effort to block a large apartment project proposed near its Charlestown manufacturing hub, Boston Sand & Gravel recently issued a grim warning: It's "inevitable" that its truck drivers will hit and kill pedestrians coming and going from the complex.

The claim is made repeatedly in a lawsuit Sand & Gravel filed April 7 in Suffolk Superior Court. The suit aims to halt a proposed 705-unit apartment project on New Rutherford Avenue, where four buildings are planned along the access road that connects the highway-wrapped Sand & Gravel complex to the rest of Boston and beyond.

Sand & Gravel has long had special rights to the access road. Putting a few thousand residents on either side, the suit claims, will inevitably invite collisions between people on foot and heavy-duty cement trucks.

The lawsuit's claims are an ominous warning — one that highlights both the challenge of finding suitable real estate to build housing in a city that's starved for it, as well as the tension between new growth and the vestiges of Boston's heavy industry.

The project would be on 5.1 acres of city-owned parking lots, today used by hundreds of

LAWSUIT, Page A7

'You always wonder, is this connected?'

NORMA AVELAR, a Westminster resident, speaking about the red welts that developed on her 4-year-old son, Maddox



Tainted wells, tortuous response

As residents await a fix ordered by state, health concerns increase

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

WESTMINSTER — In 2022, when this small town discovered hundreds of private wells had been contaminated with toxic "forever chemicals," Massachusetts environmental officials were quick to identify the likely offenders and the fix. They ordered the local composting facility and the companies that sent their waste there to resolve the problem by connecting families to uncontaminated town water.

But four years later, those companies have repeatedly blown past their cleanup deadlines, leaving Westminster residents to deal with the consequences: an unexplained rash on a child's skin; water that smells like sulfur and turns fabric orange; health conditions as severe as cancer that many here suspect were caused by the contaminated water.

Today, most residents still rely on temporary stopgaps: bottled water or filtration systems that require regular

WATER, Page A6



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Earlier this month, large water bottles were set out for pick-up in front of a home in Westminster. Several private wells have been polluted with PFAS contaminants.

Kennealy pivots on issues he once oversaw

GOP hopeful had key roles in housing, energy policies

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

As the state's top economic development official, Mike Kennealy once touted a tenet of the MBTA Communities Act as "good housing policy." He warned that the state's shelter system needed more money to accommodate an influx of people coming into the system. And he was among those consulted on the state's efforts to shift away from fossil fuels and toward so-called clean heat.

Mike Kennealy, the candidate for governor, however, has struck a different tone: He's now a critic of some of the very issues he once tackled in state government.

Kennealy, who became the first GOP candidate to launch a run against Governor Maura Healey a year ago, is distancing himself from efforts he was previously involved in under former governor Charlie Baker. Many of those issues have become punching bags within his own party and are animating the three-way Republican primary.

That includes the MBTA Communities Act, a law signed by Baker requiring communities to change zoning to allow for more multifamily housing, for which Kennealy shaped the regulations.

Similarly, Kennealy has joined other Republi-

KENNEALY, Page A7

Orban defeated

Viktor Orban (below), Hungary's autocratic leader, conceded defeat in a vote with global implications. **A3.**



SEAN GALLUP/GETTY IMAGES

Rory McIlroy, with a little drama and lots of brilliance, won the Masters, becoming only the fourth back-to-back champion. **C1.**

From radio to podcast to zany stage

Fusing Mass. pride and sass, Shearer the latest to expand platforms

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

Matt Shearer, WBZ NewsRadio's ever-viral digital reporter, said his first-ever live show would be like the "most unhinged episode of Oprah you've ever seen." That might have been an understatement.

No one got a free car, but everyone in the audience at the Wilbur Theatre Thursday night did walk away with a \$5 Dunkin' gift card. And while Tom Cruise didn't jump on a couch, there was plenty else that stood out. There was a furry (someone dressed in a full-body, tiger-like costume) delivering a box of hot sauce to Dorchester grandmother Peaches. There were drag performances from Maria Cristina False Eyelashes. And audiences heard F-bomb-filled rants about North End tourists from politically incorrect food tour guide Anthony Gesualdi.

SHEARER, Page A6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

WBZ NewsRadio's Matt Shearer took the stage at the Wilbur Theatre.



A stop shine

Monday: Midday showers, High 63-68, low 58-63.

Tuesday: Warmer, sunny. High 75-80, low 58-63.

Sunrise: 6:07. Sunset: 7:23.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 103

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Suggested retail price

\$4.00



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